

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

1 · Framework	
Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscult./Olfact.	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

2 · Shen (Vitality)			
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright/moist	Dim, dull	Dull→sudden lustrous
Eyes	Alert, twinkle	Dull, blurred	Dull→sudden bright
Mind	Clear, agile	Unconscious/delirious	Sudden change
Respiration	Even	Rapid/feeble/difficult	Feeble→brief steady

Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.

Deranged Shen	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC
Diān (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities

Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map	
Region	Organ
L cheek	Liver
Forehead	Heart
Nose	Spleen
R cheek	Lung
Chin	Kidney

3 · Five Colors of Face	
Color	Indication
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.

Secretions: Color Rule	
Finding	Meaning
Clear/white	Def./cold
Turbid/yellow	Excess/heat

6 · Nose
Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).

Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
White tip	Blood deficiency
Red tip	Heat
Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
Red bridge	Liver fire
Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
Swollen/Sunken nose	Excess/Deficiency

Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 · Ears
Kidney opens to ear.

Finding	Pattern
Dry/withered/black auricle	Kidney essence exhausted
Purulent discharge	Damp-heat Liver/GB
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency
Long full earlobes	Strong constitution
Small earlobes	Poor constitution
White/pale	Cold
Black	Kidney failure
Red	Excess heat

Tinnitus	Organ
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney

8 · Teeth/Gums/Lips/Throat	
Teeth Finding	Pattern
White, moist, bright	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Sudden dull yellow	Kidney deficiency
Gray/black	Yin+Yang exhaustion
Deviated growth	Insufficient Yangming Qi

Gums/Lips/Mouth	Pattern
Pale gums/lips	Blood deficiency
Deep red + swelling gums	Stomach fire
Purple lips	Blood stasis
Crimson lips	Yin-def. heat
Deviated mouth	Wind
Mouth remains open+fever	Excess heat
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency

4 · Appearance & Movement

Finding	Pattern
Overweight + depression	Qi def. + phlegm-damp
Thin + dry skin	Blood insufficiency
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia/wind-stroke
Tremors/convulsions	Wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stag./blood stasis/wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yin deficiency.

5 · Eyes: Five Wheels

Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids	Spleen/Stomach

Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.

Eye Color	Pattern
Yellow (bright)	Damp-heat, heat predom.
Red	Heart/Liver fire
Blue-green	Liver wind
Bluish	Internal cold / Kidney Yin def.
Dark/black sclera	Accumulated heat
White rings	Turbid phlegm

Eye Shape/Move	Pattern
Bulging/protruding	Liver Yang rising
Sunken	Lung/Spleen deficiency
Swollen, sudden	Fluid malfunction
Strabismus, sudden, no redness	Wind attacking channels
Ptosis (droopy lid)	Qi sinking or wind
Spasms + pale + thready pulse	Blood deficiency

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic (applies to nasal d/c, sputum, stool, vaginal d/c)

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis (age <3)

Gate Reached	Severity	Side	Sex
Wind Gate only	Mild / exterior	Left index finger	Boys
Qi Gate	Interior, stronger	Right index finger	Girls
Life Gate	Severe	—	—
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening	—	—

Vein Color	Indication
Light red	Normal
Bright red	Heat
Purple	Stronger heat/stasis
Green/dark blue	Wind

Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao's recorded lecture says "Nothing on the body constitutions" will be tested. Prof. Schrier's own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it (below). Confirm with Prof. Schrier which governs the quiz before deciding how hard to study Section 12.

Throat/Tonsils	Pattern
Acute red+swollen	Wind invasion (exterior)
Chronic red+swollen	Interior Stomach heat
Dry, NOT swollen, chronic	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat

9 · Hair, Nails, Skin

Hair/Nails	Pattern
Premature graying	Kidney essence depletion
Dull, brittle hair	Liver Blood deficiency
Nail pink, blanch returns fast	Sufficient Qi/Blood
Blanch returns slow	Qi/Blood exhaustion
Ridged nails	Kidney Yin def./Liver Yang rising
Spoon-shaped nails	Qi/Blood stag., Spleen def.

Skin	Pattern
Yellow orangish	Damp-heat, heat > damp
Yellow dusky	Damp-heat, damp > heat
Pitting edema	Yang def. (Spleen/Kidney)
Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation/dampness

12 · Constitutional Types (Flagged — See Heads Up Above)

Element	Physical	Personality
Wood	Green complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, tall, sinewy	Superior talent, hardworking, survives sickness
Fire	Red complexion, small head/hands/feet, curly/little hair, walks fast+sways	Frivolous w/ wealth, passionate, impulsive, curious
Earth	Yellow complexion, round face, big head, wide jaws, large abdomen	Dignified, calm, unassertive, likes helping people
Metal	Pale complexion, square face, flat abdomen, strong voice	Honest, upright, rational, leadership aptitude
Water	Dark complexion, big head, wrinkles, round body, swaying gait	Laid-back, unafraid, tendency to deceive, always moving

Constitution Marker	Weak	Strong
Eyes/nose/ears/mouth	Close together	Well-proportioned
Jaw	Flat, sunken, narrow	Strong, even, smooth
Ears	Small, short lobes	Long, long lobes

Quick Recall: Wood=tall/hardworking. Fire=curly/impulsive. Earth=round/calm. Metal=square/honest. Water=dark/deceptive.